Delivery & Returns Analytics: One-Page Insights Summary

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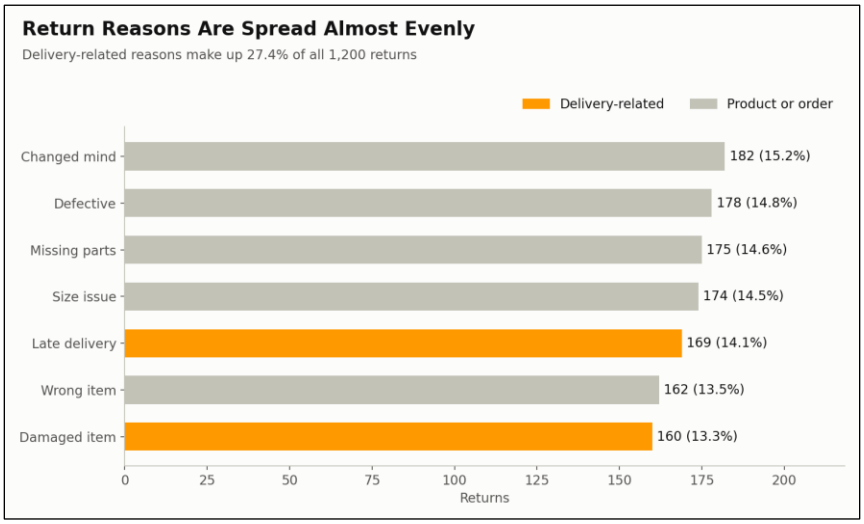
Objective: Find out how well the store delivers its orders and what causes customer returns. Delivery and returns decisions should rest on evidence.

Dataset: A retail e-commerce training dataset with 15,000 orders, 15,000 shipments through 5 couriers, and 1,200 returns, shipped from January 2024 to January 2026.

Key questions: How fast and how consistently do we deliver? Does any courier or shipping method perform better? What is the return rate, and what drives returns?

What we found

- **Most parcels arrive, but the delivery window is wide.** 77.9% of shipments were delivered. Delivered parcels take 4.0 days on average, anywhere from 1 to 7 days. No delivery time is more common than the others.
- **No courier is faster or more consistent.** All five couriers average about 4 days, with the same spread and about the same percentage of lost parcels.
- **Express is not faster than Standard.** Express takes 3.98 days and Standard takes 4.01 days. Both charge about the same fee.
- **8.0% of orders are returned, mostly for product or order reasons.** 72.6% of returns cite the product or the order. Only 27.4% cite delivery.
- **"Late delivery" returns are likely about customer expectations.** Those parcels arrived as fast as other returned parcels (median 4 days).
- **The shipment dates are not reliable.** 49.3% of ship dates are earlier than the order date. Order-to-delivered time cannot be measured yet.



Return reasons are spread almost evenly. Delivery-related reasons are 27.4% of returns.

What we recommend

- **Fix the Express promise.** Match the checkout wording to the actual 4-day delivery. Then pilot a true Express service with one courier.
- **Split returns by the team that can fix them.** Logistics owns delivery-related returns. Merchandising and the warehouse own product and order returns.
- **Record a promised delivery date for every order.** This makes "late" measurable. Test a clear delivery window at checkout in one category first.
- **Keep the current couriers.** Compare them on cost and coverage next. Speed, spread, losses, and returns show no difference large enough to justify switching couriers.
- **Record shipment dates from system scans.** Take the ship and delivered dates from courier scans. Add a daily data quality check.

Note: The no-difference findings may be a sign that the dataset is synthetic. The results describe this dataset only.